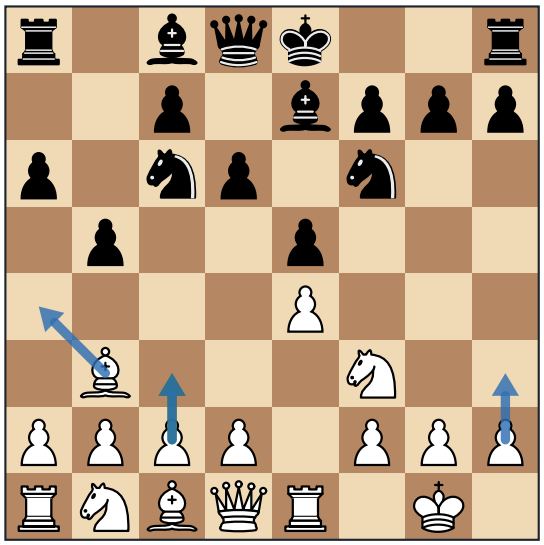
Ruy Lopez

ECO C60-C99 | 235 named lines | Ruy Lopez family

In one sentence: The classical main line of 1.e4 e5: slow pressure on e5 with endless middlegame plans and a small, lasting edge for White.

Memory pattern: Bb5 pins; castle; Re1, c3, d4: build the center slowly and keep the e4 pawn safe.



Main line: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6

Key ideas

1. Bb5 pins the knight that defends e5; the real aim is long-term pressure on the center.
2. White builds c3 and d4 in the Closed Ruy, with Re1, Bb3 and h3 as standard moves.
3. Black expands with ...b5, ...Na5 and ...c5 or ...d5 breaks.
4. Exchange Variation: damaged queenside pawns for a healthier kingside majority.
5. Berlin Defense: a solid endgame-oriented defense; Marshall: a gambit for activity.

Reading the diagram

Blue arrows = thematic plan moves for the side to move. Green arrow = engine's best move.
Engine at the end of the main line: **+0.44** (slightly better for White, depth 17). Best: c3.

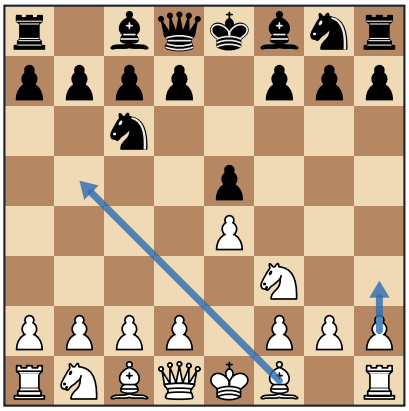
The five coach questions

1. Ideal pawn structure?	Closed Spanish centre (e4/d3 or d4 against e5/d6) or an open centre after exd4. The b5 bishop pressures the knight that guards e5.
2. Where does my king go?	Both sides castle kingside early; the bishop and Re1 keep the center under control.
3. Best minor pieces?	White: Bb3, Re1, knights d2-f1-g3. Black: Bb7, Re8, Na5/Nd7.
4. Main middlegame plan?	White prepares c3-d4 and kingside maneuvers; Black expands with ...b5, ...Na5, ...c5 and ...d5.
5. What does my opponent want?	White wants d4 at the right moment; Black wants ...d5 or queenside expansion and trades to ease the squeeze.

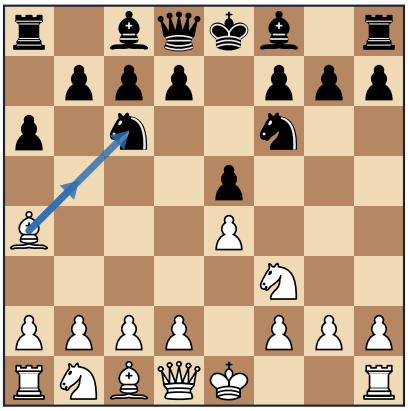
The main line, move by move

Most common continuation in the database: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6

Move	Why it is played
1. e4	Occupies the center with a pawn.
1... e5	Occupies the center with a pawn.
2. Nf3	Develops the knight to f3.
2... Nc6	Defend e5. Develops the knight to c6.
3. Bb5	Pin the knight. Develops the bishop to b5.
3... a6	Question the bishop. Gains space on the wing.
4. Ba4	Keep the pin. Repositions the bishop to a more active square.
4... Nf6	Hit e4. Develops the knight to f6.
5. O-O	Castles: the king reaches safety and the rook joins the center.
5... Be7	Develops the bishop to e7.
6. Re1	Support e4. Rook move: contests an open file or the center.
6... b5	Gain space. Gains space on the wing.
7. Bb3	Keep the bishop. Repositions the bishop to a more active square.
7... d6	Support e5. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.



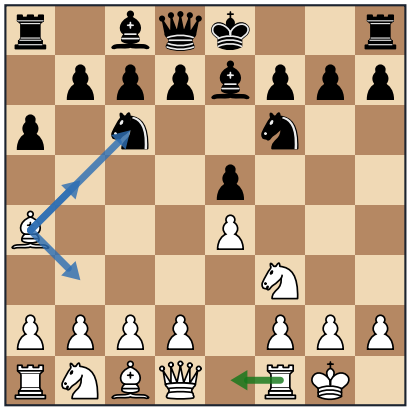
After 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6



After Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6

Key variations

The most important named branches (ranked by how much theory lies beneath them). Diagram arrows: blue = plan moves, green = Stockfish.

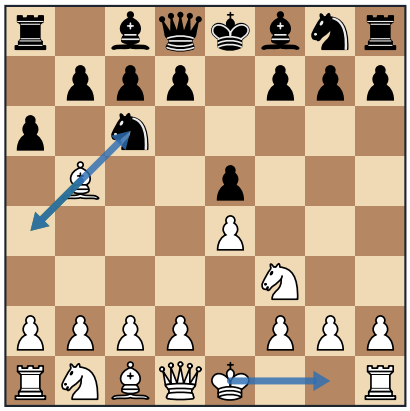


Position after the line

Closed C84 | 53 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7`

Stockfish: **+0.45** (slightly better for White, depth 19). Best next move: Re1.
What to look for: Bb5 (pin the knight); Ba4 (keep the pin); O-O (castle)
Sub-variations: Chigorin Defense, Breyer Defense, Worrall Attack, Center Attack

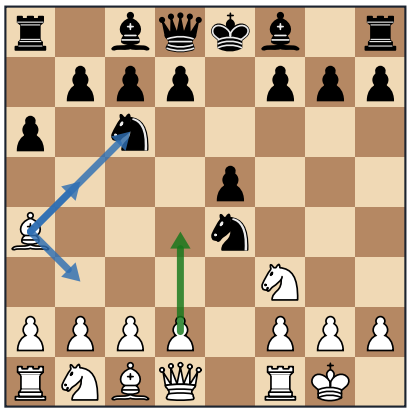


Position after the line

Morphy Defense C70 | 39 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6`

Stockfish: **+0.33** (slightly better for White, depth 17). Best next move: Ba4.
What to look for: Bb5 (pin the knight); Ba4 (keep the pin); O-O (castle)
Sub-variations: Modern Steinitz Defense, Norwegian Variation, Schliemann Defense Deferred, Steinitz Deferred

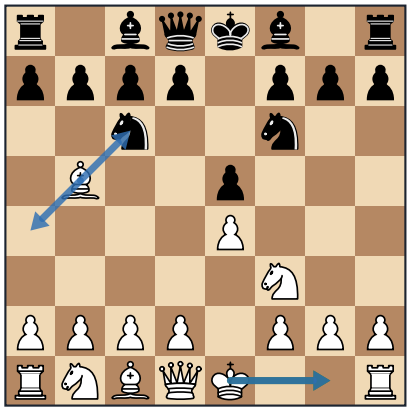


Position after the line

Open C80 | 33 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4`

Stockfish: **+0.38** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: d4.
What to look for: Bb5 (pin the knight); Ba4 (keep the pin); O-O (castle)
Sub-variations: Howell Attack, Classical Defense, Bernstein Variation, Motzko Attack



Position after the line

Berlin Defense C65 | 31 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6`

Stockfish: **+0.20** (equal, depth 15). Best next move: O-O.
What to look for: Bb5 (pin the knight); Ba4 (keep the pin); O-O (castle)
Sub-variations: Anti-Berlin Variation, l'Hermet Variation, Rio de Janeiro Variation, Beverwijk Variation

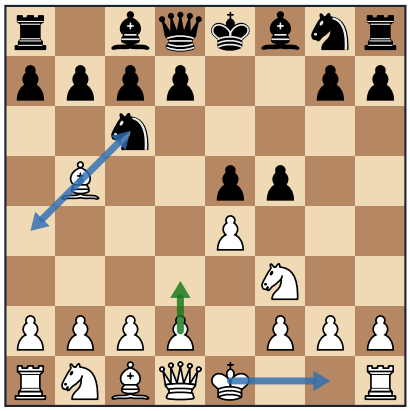


Position after the line

Exchange Variation C68 | 10 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6`

Stockfish: **-0.21** (equal, depth 16). Best next move: dxc6.
What to look for: Nc6 (defend e5); a6 (question the bishop); Nf6 (hit e4)
Sub-variations: Alekhine Variation, Keres Variation, Lutikov Variation, Romanovsky Variation



Position after the line

Schliemann Defense C63 | 9 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5`

Stockfish: **+0.54** (slightly better for White, depth 14). Best next move: d3.
What to look for: Bb5 (pin the knight); Ba4 (keep the pin); O-O (castle)
Sub-variations: Classical Variation, Dyckhoff Variation, Exchange Variation, Jaenisch Gambit Accepted

Detailed repertoire notes

Ruy Lopez (Closed) (C84-C99, White)

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3`

Idea: Pin and pressure the e5 pawn, build c3 + d4, keep the bishop pair tension on the a2-g8 diagonal.

Structure: Pawns e4/d3 or c3/d4 against e5/d6. Typical outcome: a closed center where White plays d4 at the best moment, or a slow maneuvering game.

Pieces: Bb3 eyes f7, Nbd2-f1-g3, Re1 backs e4/d4, Qc2/Qe2. The a2-g8 bishop is White's best piece; keep it.

Plan: Complete c3-h3-d4, reroute Nb1 (d2-f1-g3 or Nbd2-b3), then d4 or a kingside attack with Nf5/Bg5. Black counters with ...c5, ...Nc6-a5 and ...Bb7.

King: Castle kingside by move 5; Re1 and h3 support the center. **Opponent:** ...b5 and ...d6 to kick the bishop, then ...Na5/...c5; the Marshall (...d5) is the sharp try.

Watch out: Marshall Gambit (8...d5) is Black's sharp weapon: avoid with 8.a4 (Anti-Marshall) if you do not want to learn it.

Ruy Lopez: Berlin Defense (C65-C67, Black)

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6 6.Bxc6 dxc6 7.dxe5 Nf5 8.Qxd8+ Kxd8 9.Nc3 Ke8 10.h3 h5 11.Bf4 Be7 12.Rad1 Be6`

Idea: Trade queens early and rely on the bishop pair and a stable structure; White has a small edge but Black is safe.

Structure: Black has doubled c-pawns but the bishop pair and open lines compensate; the structure is solid.

Pieces: Bishops e6/e7, knight f5/d7, king e8, rooks d8/h8.

Plan: Complete development, play ...Ke8, ...h5 and ...Be6; use the bishop pair and keep the pawn majority.

King: The king walks to e8 or g8 after queens trade; ...Ke8 and ...h5 setups. **Opponent:** A pawn-structure endgame with the bishop pair; Black wants to keep it solid.

Watch out: White's endgame edge is small, but you need patience.

Expert and coach view

The Ruy Lopez has been a main weapon of Lasker, Capablanca, Fischer and Carlsen.

What a coach would tell you

Learn the closed structure: c3, d4, Nbd2-f1-g3 and the plans for both sides. Choose either the Main Line (Bb3, c3, h3) or the Exchange for a simpler game. If you dislike theory, play the Exchange.

Why play it

The classical main line of 1.e4 e5: slow pressure on e5 with endless middlegame plans and a small, lasting edge for White.

Typical mistakes

- Giving up the bishop on c6 without a plan for the resulting pawn structure.
- Playing d4 before the center is supported (c3, Re1) and losing the e4 pawn.
- Allowing ...d5 breaks without preparation in the Closed Ruy.

Typical tactics and traps

- The Marshall Gambit (...d5) is a deep, forcing line; know it or sidestep with 8.a4 (Anti-Marshall).
- Bxc6 followed by Nxe5 winning a pawn when e5 loses its protector.

Endgame and middlegame outlook

Closed Ruy: slow maneuvering. Exchange and Berlin lines lead to endings where pawn structure and bishop pair decide.

Study checklist

[ ] Play the main line on a board and say each move's purpose aloud.

[ ] Learn the five coach questions by heart; answer them without notes.

[ ] Drill two sub-variations until the moves feel automatic.

[ ] Play three games with the opening, then review where you left theory.

[ ] Re-read the traps page the day before a tournament.

The opening tree

Every named line in this family as a tree. Gray moves are inherited from the parent; green after the arrow are the new moves that define the variation. Large green dots mark branches with 10 or more lines.

- **Ruy Lopez (all lines)** — C60
  `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5`
  - **Classical Defense** — C64
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5`
    - **Boden Variation** — C64
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Bc5 4.c3 Qe7`
    - **Zaitsev Variation** — C64
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Bc5 4.O-O Nd4 5.b4`
    - **Benelux Variation** — C64
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nf6 4.O-O Bc5 5.c3 O-O 6.d4 Bb6`
  - **Alapin Defense** — C60
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Bb4`
    - **Alapin Gambit** — C60
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Bb4 -> 4.c3 Ba5 5.Bxc6 dxc6`
  - **Berlin Defense** — C65
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nf6`
    - **Anti-Berlin Variation** — C65
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.d3`
      - **Mortimer Variation** — C65
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.d3 -> 4...Ne7`
      - **Anderssen Variation** — C65
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.d3 -> 4...d6 5.Bxc6`
      - **Duras Variation** — C65
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.d3 -> 4...d6 5.c4`
      - **Kaufmann Variation** — C65
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.d3 -> 4...Bc5 5.Be3`
      - **Mortimer Trap** — C65
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.d3 -> 4...Ne7 5.Nxe5 c6`
    - **Beverwijk Variation** — C65
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Bc5`
    - **Fishing Pole Variation** — C65
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Ng4`
    - **Improved Steinitz Defense** — C66
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O d6`
    - **Rio Gambit Accepted** — C67
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4`
    - **Nyholm Attack** — C65
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O`
    - **Rio de Janeiro Variation** — C67
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7`
    - **Rosenthal Variation** — C67
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 a6`
    - **l'Hermet Variation** — C67
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6`
      - **Westerinen Line** — C67
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6 -> 6.Bxc6 dxc6 7.dxe5 Ne4`
      - **Berlin Wall Defense** — C67
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6 -> 6.Bxc6 dxc6 7.dxe5 Nf5 8.Qxd8 Kxd8`
    - **Minckwitz Variation** — C67
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7 6.dxe5`
    - **Closed Wolf Variation** — C66
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O d6 5.d4 Bd7 6.Nc3 exd4`
    - **Hedgehog Variation** — C66
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O d6 5.d4 Bd7 6.Nc3 Be7`
    - **Trifunovic Variation** — C67
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7 6.Qe2 d5`
    - **Closed Bernstein Variation** — C66
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O d6 5.d4 Bd7 6.Nc3 Be7 7.Bg5`

- **Closed Showalter Variation** C66
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O d6 5.d4 Bd7 6.Nc3 Be7 7.Bxc6
- **Tarrasch Trap** C66
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d6 4.d4 Bd7 5.Nc3 Nf6 6.O-O Be7 7.Re1 O-O
- **Cordel Variation** C67
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7 6.Qe2 Nd6 7.Bxc6 bxc6 8.dxe5 Nf5
- **Pillsbury Variation** C67
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7 6.Qe2 Nd6 7.Bxc6 bxc6 8.dxe5 Nb7 9.b3
- **Winawer Attack** C67
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7 6.Qe2 Nd6 7.Bxc6 bxc6 8.dxe5 Nb7 9.Nd4
- **Zukertort Variation** C67
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Be7 6.Qe2 Nd6 7.Bxc6 bxc6 8.dxe5 Nb7 9.c4
- **Berlin Wall** C67
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 -> 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6 6.Bxc6 dxc6 7.dxe5 Nf5 8.Qxd8 Kxd8 9.Nc3 Bd7

- **Bird Variation** C61
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nd4
  - **Paulsen Variation** C61
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nd4 -> 4.Nxd4 exd4 5.O-O Ne7

- **Brentano Gambit** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...g5

- **Bulgarian Variation** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a5

- **Classical Variation** C64
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Bc5
  - **Central Variation** C64
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Bc5 -> 4.c3
  - **Spanish Wing Gambit** C64
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Bc5 -> 4.b4
  - **Charousek Variation** C64
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Bb6
  - **Cordel Gambit** C64
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Bc5 -> 4.c3 f5
  - **Konikowski Gambit** C64
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Bc5 -> 4.c3 d5
  - **Zukertort Gambit** C65
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Bc5 5.c3
  - **Modern Main Line** C64
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Bc5 5.c3 O-O 6.d4 Bb6 7.Bg5

- **Cozio Defense** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nge7
  - **Paulsen Variation** C60
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nge7 -> 4.Nc3 g6
  - **Tartakower Gambit** C60
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 g6 4.d4 exd4 5.Nxd4 Bg7 6.Be3 Nge7 7.Nc3 O-O 8.Qd2 d5

- **Fianchetto Defense** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...g6
  - **Kevitz Gambit** C60
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 g6 -> 4.c3 f5

- **Lucena Variation** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Be7

- **Morphy Defense** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6
  - **Alapin's Defense Deferred** C70
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Bb4
  - **Caro Variation** C70
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 b5
  - **Classical Defense Deferred** C70
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Bc5

- **Cozio Defense** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nge7
- **Fianchetto Defense Deferred** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 g6
- **Modern Steinitz Defense** C71
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 d6
  - **Siesta Variation** C74
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 d6 -> 5.c3 f5
  - **Fianchetto Variation** C76
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 g6 4.c3 a6 5.Ba4 d6 6.d4 Bd7
- **Schliemann Defense Deferred** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 f5
  - **Jaenisch Gambit Deferred** C70
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 f5 -> 5.exf5
- **Anderssen Variation** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.d3
- **Bayreuth Variation** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.Bxc6
- **Jaffe Gambit** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.c3
- **Mackenzie Variation** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.d4
- **Tarrasch Variation** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.Nc3
- **Wormald Attack** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.Qe2
- **Graz Variation** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 b5 5.Bb3 Bc5
- **Møller Variation** C78
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Bc5
- **Norwegian Variation** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 b5 5.Bb3 Na5
  - **Nightingale Gambit** C70
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 b5 5.Bb3 Na5 -> 6.Bxf7
- **Steinitz Deferred** C79
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O d6
- **Duras Variation** C77
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.d3 d6 6.c4
- **Tartakower Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.Qe2
- **Arkhangelsk Variation** C78
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O b5 6.Bb3 Bb7
- **Neo-Arkhangelsk Variation** C78
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O b5 6.Bb3 Bc5
- **Wing Attack** C78
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 -> 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O b5 6.Bb3 Be7 7.a4
- **Nürnberg Variation** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...f6
- **Pollock Defense** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Na5
- **Retreat Variation** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nb8
- **Rotary-Albany Gambit** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...b6
- **Schliemann Defense** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...f5
  - **Dyckhoff Variation** C63
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.Nc3

- **Exchange Variation** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.Bxc6
- **Jaenisch Gambit Accepted** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.exf5
- **Schönemann Attack** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.d4
- **Kostić Defense** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.Nc3 fxe4 5.Nxe4 Be7
- **Tartakower Variation** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.Nc3 fxe4 5.Nxe4 Nf6
- **Classical Variation** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.Nc3 fxe4 5.Nxe4 d5 6.Nxe5 dxe4 7.Nxc6 Qg5
- **Möhring Variation** C63
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 f5 -> 4.Nc3 fxe4 5.Nxe4 d5 6.Nxe5 dxe4 7.Nxc6 Qd5

- **Spanish Countergambit** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...d5
  - **Harding Countergambit** C60
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d5 -> 4.Nxe5 Qg5 5.O-O
    - **Fricke Gambit** C60
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d5 4.Nxe5 Qg5 5.O-O
  - **Harding Gambit** C60
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d5 -> 4.Nxe5 Qg5 5.Nxc6

- **Steinitz Defense** C62
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...d6
  - **Center Gambit** C62
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d6 -> 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O
  - **Semi-Duras Variation** C62
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d6 -> 4.d4 Bd7 5.c4
  - **Nimzowitsch Attack** C62
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 d6 -> 4.d4 Bd7 5.Nc3 Nf6 6.Bxc6

- **Vinogradov Variation** C60
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Qe7

- **Exchange Variation** C68
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Bxc6
  - **Lutikov Variation** C68
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...bxc6
  - **Keres Variation** C68
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.Nc3
  - **Normal Variation** C69
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.O-O
  - **Bronstein Variation** C69
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.O-O Qd6
  - **Gligoric Variation** C69
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.O-O f6
  - **King's Bishop Variation** C69
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.O-O Bd6
  - **Romanovsky Variation** C68
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.Nc3 f6 6.d3
  - **Alapin Gambit** C69
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.O-O Bg4 6.h3 h5
  - **Alekhine Variation** C68
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 -> 4...dxc6 5.d4 exd4 6.Qxd4 Qxd4 7.Nxd4 Bd6

- **Halloween Attack** C65
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nf6 4.Nxe5
- **Bird's Defense Deferred** C70
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nd4
- **Brix Variation** C78
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O g6

- **Central Countergambit** C78
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O d5
- **Closed** C84
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7
  - **Center Attack** C84
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.d4
    - **Basque Gambit** C84
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.d4 -> 6...exd4 7.e5 Ne4 8.c3 dxc3
  - **Delayed Exchange** C85
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Bxc6
  - **Martinez Variation** C84
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.d3
  - **Morphy Attack** C84
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Nc3
  - **Worrall Attack** C86
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Qe2
    - **Castling Line** C86
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Qe2 -> 6...b5 7.Bb3 O-O
    - **Delayed Castling Line** C86
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Qe2 -> 6...b5 7.Bb3 d6
  - **Averbakh Variation** C87
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 d6
  - **Trajkovic Counterattack** C88
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 Bb7
  - **Anti-Marshall** C88
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.a4
  - **Basque Gambit** C84
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.d4 exd4 7.e5 Ne4 8.c3
  - **Rosen Attack** C88
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.d4
  - **Lutikov Variation** C90
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.Bc2
  - **Pilnik Variation** C90
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.d3 d6 9.c3
  - **Suetin Variation** C90
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.a3
  - **Yates Variation** C91
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.d4
    - **Short Attack** C91
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.d4 -> 9...Bg4 10.a4
  - **Bogoljubow Variation** C91
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.d4 Bg4
  - **Breyer Defense** C94
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Nb8
    - **Quiet Variation** C94
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Nb8 -> 10.d3
    - **Zaitsev Hybrid** C95
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Nb8 -> 10.d4 Nbd7
  - **Chigorin Defense** C97
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5
    - **Gajewski Gambit** C96
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 -> 10.Bc2 d5
    - **Panov System** C99
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 -> 10.Bc2 c5 11.d4 Qc…
  - **Flohr System** C92
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Bb7
  - **Karpov Variation** C92
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Nd7

- **Kecskemet Variation** C72
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 d6 5.O-O Bd7 6.c3 Nf6 7.d4 Be7 8.Nbd2 O-O 9.Re1 Be8
- **Kholmov Variation** C92
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Be6
- **Smyslov Defense** C93
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 h6
- **Zaitsev System** C92
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Re8
- **Breyer** C95
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Nb8 10.d4
- **Balla Variation** C88
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 Na5 9.Bc2 c5 10.d4 Qc7 11.a4
- **Borisenko Variation** C96
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 10.Bc2 c5 11.d4 Nc6
- **Keres Defense** C96
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 10.Bc2 c5 11.d4 Nd7
- **Rossolimo Defense** C96
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 10.Bc2 c6 11.d4 Qc7
- **Smyslov-Breyer-Zaitsev Hybrid** C92
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Bb7 10.d4 Re8 11.Nbd2 Bf8 1…
- **Leonhardt Variation** C88
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 Na5 9.Bc2 c5 10.d4 Qc7 11.h3 Nc6 12.d…
- **Alekhine Gambit** C88
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 Na5 9.Bc2 c5 10.d4 Qc7 11.Nbd2 O-O 12…
- **Chigorin** C97
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 -> 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 10.Bc2 c5 11.d4 Qc7 12…
  - **Yugoslav System** C97
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 d6 8.c3 O-O 9.h3 Na5 10.Bc2 c5 11.d4 Qc7 12.Nbd2 Bd7 13.Nf

Closed Berlin Defense C66
1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nf6 4.O-O d6 5.d4 Nd7

- **Chigorin Variation** C66
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O d6 5.d4 Nd7

Open C80
1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4

- **Knorre Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.Nc3
- **Riga Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 exd4
- **Skipworth Gambit** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.Re1 d5
- **Friess Attack** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Nxe5
- **Richter Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.d5
- **Harksen Gambit** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.c4
- **Main Line** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6
- **Schlechter Defense** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.a4 Nxd4
- **Zukertort Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Ne7
- **Bernstein Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.Nbd2
  - **Luther Line** C80
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.Nbd2 -> 9...Bc5 10.Qe1
- **Howell Attack** C81
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.Qe2

- **Ekstrom Variation** C81
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.Qe2 -> 9...Be7 10.Rd1 O-O …
- **Berlin Variation** C82
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Nc5
- **Classical Defense** C83
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Be7
  - **Main Line** C83
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.d4 Be7 7.Re1 b5 8.Bb3 d5 9.dxe5 Be6 10.c3
- **Italian Variation** C82
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Bc5
- **Berger Variation** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.a4 Nxd4 9.Nxd4 exd4 10.Nc3
- **Motzko Attack** C82
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Bc5 10.Qd3
  - **Nenarokov Variation** C82
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Bc5 10.Qd3 -> 10...Ne7
- **St. Petersburg Variation** C82
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Bc5 10.Nbd2
- **Karpov Gambit** C80
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.Nbd2 Nc5 10.c3 d4 11.Ng5
- **Malkin Variation** C83
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Be7 10.Nbd2 O-O 11.Qe2
- **Breslau Variation** C83
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Be7 10.Re1 O-O 11.Nd4 Nxe5
- **Dilworth Variation** C82
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Bc5 10.Nbd2 O-O 11.Bc2 Nxf2
- **Tarrasch Trap** C83
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 -> 6.d4 b5 7.Bb3 d5 8.dxe5 Be6 9.c3 Be7 10.Re1 O-O 11.Nd4 Qd…
- **Open Berlin Defense** C67
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...Nf6 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6
  - **Showalter Variation** C67
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6 -> 6.Ba4
  - **l'Hermet Variation** C67
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nf6 4.O-O Nxe4 5.d4 Nd6 -> 6.dxe5
- **Steinitz Defense Deferred** C79
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O d6 6.Bxc6 bxc6 7.d4
  - **Lipnitsky Variation** C79
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O d6 6.Bxc6 bxc6 7.d4 -> 7...Bg4
  - **Boleslavsky Variation** C79
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O d6 6.Bxc6 bxc6 7.d4 -> 7...Nxe4 8.Re1 f5 9.dxe5 d5 10.Nc3
- **Exchange** C68
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Bxc6 dxc6 5.d4 exd4 6.Qxd4 Qxd4 7.Nxd4 Bd7
  - **Alekhine Variation** C68
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 dxc6 5.d4 exd4 6.Qxd4 Qxd4 7.Nxd4 Bd7
- **Marshall Attack** C89
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5
  - **Steiner Variation** C89
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 -> 9.exd5 e4
  - **Modern Variation** C89
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 -> 9.exd5 Nxd5 10.Nxe5 Nxe5 11.Rxe…
  - **Original Marshall Attack** C89
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 -> 9.exd5 Nxd5 10.Nxe5 Nxe5 11.Rxe5…
  - **Main Line** C89
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 -> 9.exd5 Nxd5 10.Nxe5 Nxe5 11.Rxe…
    - **Spassky Variation** C89
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 9.exd5 Nxd5 10.Nxe5 Nxe5 11.Rxe5 c6 12.d4 -> 1
  - **Re3 Variation** C89
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 -> 9.exd5 Nxd5 10.Nxe5 Nxe5 11.Rxe…

- **Modern Main Line** C89
  `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 6.Re1 b5 7.Bb3 O-O 8.c3 d5 -> 9.exd5 Nxd5 10.Nxe5 Nxe5 11.Rxe5…`
- **Noah's Ark Trap** C71
  `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 b5 5.Bb3 d6 6.d4 Nxd4 7.Nxd4 exd4 8.Qxd4 c5`
- **Wormald Attack** C77
  `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.Qe2 b5 6.Bb3 Be7 7.d4 d6 8.c3 Bg4`
  - **Grünfeld Variation** C77
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.Qe2 b5 6.Bb3 Be7 7.d4 d6 8.c3 Bg4`
- **Rabinovich Variation** C78
  `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 -> 3...a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O b5 6.Bb3 d6 7.Ng5 d5 8.exd5 Nd4 9.Re1 Bc5 10.Rxe5 Kf8`

One-page memory sheet

Move-order pattern

```
1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.0-0 Be7
```

Plan chain

White	Bb5 -> Ba4 -> O-O -> Re1 -> c3
Black	Nc6 -> a6 -> Nf6 -> Be7 -> b5

Three rules to remember

1. Bb5 pins; castle; Re1, c3, d4: build the center slowly and keep the e4 pawn safe.

2. White prepares c3-d4 and kingside maneuvers; Black expands with ...b5, ...Na5, ...c5 and ...d5.

3. White wants d4 at the right moment; Black wants ...d5 or queenside expansion and trades to ease the squeeze.

Pawn structure in one line

Closed Spanish centre (e4/d3 or d4 against e5/d6) or an open centre after exd4. The b5 bishop pressures the knight that guards e5.